

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4 3
 ♥ 10 7 6 2
 ♦ J 7 6
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8

♥ A J 5

♦ A 3

♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ K Q 10 5 2

♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K Q

♦ 9 8 4

♣ K Q 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			

6♣ by North
 a ♠ loser from your hand.

The slam was easy to bid, now you just have to make it. North plays 6♣. East leads the ♦Q.

You have one certain ♦ loser, and a two-way finesse for the ♠Q. That should make you start thinking about elimination and throw-in. So win the ♦A and pull trumps, East having a singleton.

Now eliminate ♥s from your hand and dummy by playing ♥K, ♥A, ♥J. **BUT BE CAREFUL!** On the ♥J you must discard a ♦ from dummy so both of you will be out of ♦s at the throw-in.

NOW you can execute the throw-in. Play your ♦, which eliminates ♦s from both you and dummy and at the same time throws in one of the defenders. Whoever it is will be forced to lead a ♠ and eliminate your guess for the ♠Q or else give you a ruff-sluff, allowing you to ruff in dummy and discard

Among Bridge players you often hear about someone (usually Aunt Harriet) who is amazingly lucky at guessing the location of missing Queens.

Perhaps Aunt Harriet isn't that lucky after all, perhaps she just knows how to perform elimination plays.

Hopefully in the future you will be the one with the reputation!

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

West

North

East

South

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

1 ♠

4 ♥

When the bidding gets high in a hurry you sometimes have to guess what you can make. East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥ K.

And it looks like you are too high. Assuming the trumps split 2-1, you still have one ♥ loser, two ♦ losers and one ♣ loser.

You win the ♥ A and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. North discards a ♦!

From bad to worse. Now you must add a ♠ loser to the four you already had. Are you finished?

No, never give up. South has a bunch of ♥s and 3 ♠s, so he cannot have many ♦s and ♣s. If you can eliminate those and then throw him in it should work to your advantage.

Play your ♠ A, the ♦ A and the ♣ A K. South follows to everything.

You've done all you can do. Now play the ♥ 10 to South's high ♥.

South has just won his side's first trick with the ♥ J. He now plays the ♠ Q, winning his side's second trick.

Now, South is still on lead, and he has nothing in his hand but good ♥s. So he leads one of them, and you **DO NOT RUFF**. Instead you discard a ♣ from dummy and a ♦ from your own hand. South has now taken his side's third trick. He plays another good ♥, and you ruff in dummy and discard the last ♦ loser from your hand. You can now cross-ruff for the rest of the tricks.

Incredible isn't it.

You just wonder how many bridge players would have just conceded down 2 on this hand.

Not you or me, of course.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ K 8 2
 ♦ K Q 10 3 2
 ♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

small ♥ from your hand. West wins his ♦ Q (which his opening lead told you he held) and is end-played. He must lead a ♥ to your tenace or give you a ruff-sluff.

The answer to the question posed above is:

It is a pretty simple problem, but you are no doubt getting a lot better.

North's 3 ♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points in support of ♠s. When you discover that the raise includes two Aces you bid the slam. South plays 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ K, won by you with dummy's ♦ A.

Is this a really easy elimination play showing up this late in the group? Or are you just getting better at seeing them? In any case, you should see that a successful ♥ finesse will land your contract, but you should also remember that there aren't many finesses working on these 25 deals.

So rather than finesse, eliminate! Pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

Ruff the ♦ 6, then play ♣ A, ♣ K, ♣ Q.

So here you are in dummy. Do you finesse the ♥ now? Of course not. You play the ♦ J and discard a

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

Board 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 8

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 9

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ 5
♣ A K 3

Board 10

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 12

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

Board 13

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 15

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ 5
♣ A K 3

Board 16

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 18

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

Board 19

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 20

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 21

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ 5
♣ A K 3

Board 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 24

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

Board 25

North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 26

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 27 ♠ A 10 9 3

South Deals ♥ 7 5 4

None Vul ♦ A J 6

♠ 6

♥ K 8 2

♦ K Q 10 3 2

♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 754

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5

♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

◆ 5

♣ A K 3



Board 28

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 29

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 30

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ A J 6

♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5

♥ J 10 9 6

♦ 9 8 7 4

♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2

♥ A Q 3

♦ 5

♣ A K 3

Board 31

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8

♥ A J 5

♦ A 3

♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5

♥ 9 8 4 3

♦ K Q 10 5 2

♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K Q

♦ 9 8 4

♣ K Q 8 4

Board 32

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 33

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ 5
♣ A K 3

Board 34

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ J 7 6
♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8
♥ A J 5
♦ A 3
♣ A J 10 7 2



♠ 9 6 5
♥ 9 8 4 3
♦ K Q 10 5 2
♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2
♥ K Q
♦ 9 8 4
♣ K Q 8 4

Board 35

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2



♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

Board 36

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6
♥ K 8 2
♦ K Q 10 3 2
♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ A J 6
♣ Q 7 5



♠ 8 5
♥ J 10 9 6
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ 5
♣ A K 3